

Chess in Coventry, every Tuesday evening

Whether you have just learned the moves or you have played league chess for decades, there is a board and a game waiting for you at Massey Ferguson Social Club from 7:30pm.

Visit the club

Read the blog

CLUB NIGHT

Tuesdays, 7:30pm

LEAGUES

Coventry &
Leamington

JUNIORS

Weekly section



The Italian Game — one of the openings you will meet on a club night

Latest from the club

All posts

NEWS

28 February 2026 · Simon Weaver

End of season dates for 2026

The Summer Cup begins on 24 March, and the club AGM is on 19 May. Here are the dates for the rest of the season.

Read the full post →

POSITION

28 July 2026

Club night puzzle: a rook ending worth knowing

This position, or something very like it, decides more league games than any opening you will ever study.

ANNOTATED GAME

14 July 2026

The Opera House Game, and what it still teaches us

Morphy against the Duke of Brunswick and Count Isouard, Paris 1858 — seventeen moves that explain development better than any textbook chapter.

NEWS

20 October 2025

How to improve at chess

The advice our stronger players give most often, collected in one place — from tactics and openings through to the endgame and the mental side of the game.

NEWS

2 July 2025

Summer information and coaching details

The league programme is complete, the club stays open through the summer for friendly chess, and we are hoping to enter five teams next season.

Positions & games

All games

Annotated games and puzzles from our players, on a proper board you can play through.



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Rhys Edwards

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Paul Morphy 1-0 Duke of Brunswick and Count Isouard
Casual game, Paris Opera House

Morphy against the Duke of Brunswick and Count Isouard, Paris 1858 — seventeen moves that explain development better than any textbook chapter.

Rhys Edwards

Read →



New to the club?

Just turn up on a Tuesday evening — there is no need to book, and your first few visits are free. Bring nothing but yourself; we have the boards, sets and clocks.

Ask us a question



League chess

We enter teams across the divisions of the Coventry & District League, plus a side in the Leamington League. If you fancy competitive play, there is a board for you at whatever standard you are.



Junior section

Our junior section runs on club nights (Tuesday, 6:00pm – 7:15pm), coaching young players from the basic moves through to their first competitive games.

Enquire about juniors

Where to find us

We meet at Massey Ferguson Social Club on Broad Lane, Coventry, which kindly provides our venue every week. There is parking on site and a bar.

Massey Ferguson Social Club

Broad Lane, Coventry

CV5 7NL

Open in maps

Contact the club

A TYPICAL CLUB NIGHT

6:00pm Junior section: coaching and graded games for young players.

7:30pm Club opens for the evening. League matches begin, and anyone not playing a fixture gets a friendly game.

Later Post-mortems at the bar — usually where the most instructive chess of the night happens.

Coventry Chess Club

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Leamington League

English Chess Federation

Club blog

Club news and fixtures, annotated games from our players, and positions worth a second look — all on a board you can play through.

Everything

News

Positions

Games

Search posts and players.

Search



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Simon Weaver

[Read →](#)

NEWS 20 October 2025

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Simon Weaver

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NEWS 2 July 2025

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The league programme is complete, the club stays open through the summer for friendly chess, and we are hoping to enter five teams next season.

Simon Weaver

[Read →](#)

NEWS 26 February 2025

Spring and summer 2025 dates

A ten-minute tournament in March, then the Summer Cup running from April into May, with the AGM on 3 June.

Simon Weaver

[Read →](#)

NEWS 23 December 2024

Christmas and new year opening times

The club is open on 10 and 17 December for social chess, closed over Christmas and new year, and reopens on 7 January.

Simon Weaver

[Read →](#)

NEWS 26 October 2024

Malcolm Harding: funeral arrangements

Arrangements for Malcolm Harding, whose funeral was held at Rainsbrook Crematorium on 13 November 2024.

Simon Weaver

[Read →](#)

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ANNOTATED GAME 14 July 2026

The Opera House Game, and what it still teaches us

RE

Rhys Edwards
Club member · ECF 2015

WHITE

Paul Morphy

BLACK

Duke of Brunswick and Count Isouard

RESULT

1-0

EVENT

Casual game, Paris Opera House
1 Oct 1858

MOVES

1. e4 e5
2. Nf3 d6
The Philidor Defence. Solid enough, but it does nothing for Black's development, and against Morphy that is a luxury nobody could afford.
3. d4 Bg4
A natural-looking move that turns out to be the root of all Black's problems: the bishop will simply be chased, losing time.
4. dxe5 Bxf3
5. Qxf3 dxe5
6. Bc4 Nf6
Every white move so far has developed a piece or opened a line. Black, by contrast, has moved a bishop twice and traded it off.
7. Qb3 Qe7
Hitting f7 twice and asking a question Black

POSITION (FEN)

rnbqkbnr/pppppppp/8/8/8/8/PPPPPPPP/RN

Starting position

Full notation

Analyse this game on lichess → Copy the PGN

Show the raw PGN

Every club has an evening where somebody loses a game they never really played. Pieces stay at home, a bishop wanders out and gets chased back, and by move twelve the position is technically equal and practically hopeless. The game above, played by Paul Morphy in a box at the Paris Opera House in 1858, is the purest illustration of why that happens.

What Morphy actually does

Count the moves. By move nine, White has developed four pieces, castled is available at any moment, and every single move has either brought a piece out or opened a line. Black has moved a bishop twice, traded it off, and pushed pawns.

That is the whole game. The sacrifices from move ten onwards are not brilliance conjured from nothing — they are the natural consequence of having three more pieces in play than your opponent.

The move worth memorising

12. O-O-O! is the move to take away from this. Castling is usually a quiet, housekeeping move. Here it is an attacking move: the king gets to safety *and* the rook lands on the open d-file where the pin is already fatal. When you are looking for a way to bring your last piece into an attack, ask whether castling does it.

How to use this game

Play it through on the board above, then try this: set the position up after 9. Bg5 and play it out against a club mate, taking the black side. It is instructive precisely because Black is not yet lost by any material count — and losing it anyway teaches the lesson better than reading about it.

If you would like more of this sort of thing, the [Fun Stuff](#) page collects puzzles and links, and one-to-one [coaching](#) is available through the club.

More chess posts

POSITION
Club night puzzle: a rook ending worth knowing
28 July 2026

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Boards by [Chessground](#) (lichess) [Members' login](#)

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POSITION 28 July 2026

Club night puzzle: a rook ending worth knowing

RE Rhys Edwards
Club member · ECF 2015



POSITION

White to move

White to play and draw. There is exactly one move that holds.

► Show the answer

FEN

8/8/8/8/8/1k6/1p6/1K1R4 w - - 0 1

Copy

Open in the lichess analysis board →

Rook endings are where league points are quietly won and lost. Most club players know roughly how to push a passed pawn, and almost nobody has looked at what to do when the defence is a single well-placed rook.

Try the position above before reading the answer. White is a pawn down against a rook and a king, and there is precisely one move that saves the half point.

Why this one matters

It is not an artificial study. Positions of this shape — one pawn, one rook each side, kings close — turn up several times a season in the Coventry League, usually at about half past ten when everybody is tired. Knowing the rule saves you the trouble of finding it at the board.

The rule to remember

*With a rook against a pawn on the seventh, get your rook **as far away as the board allows** along the file, so it can check from behind without being caught. Short-side checks fail; long-side checks hold.*

Practise it

Set the position up with a club mate and play both sides. Then move the pawn to c2, and to a2, and see which of them changes the assessment. That half hour will be worth more to your grade than a new opening line.

If you want to work through endgames systematically, the free [lichess practice](#) lessons cover this material well, and our [coaching page](#) explains how to arrange one-to-one sessions.

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NEWS 20 October 2025

How to improve at chess

SW Simon Weaver
Club administrator

Improving at chess is less mysterious than it looks. Almost everyone who gets meaningfully better does the same handful of things, and almost everyone who plateaus is skipping one of them. Here is the advice our stronger players give most often.

Get the fundamentals right first

Before anything clever, make sure the basics are automatic: develop your pieces towards the centre, castle early, do not move the same piece repeatedly in the opening, and do not bring the queen out to be chased. The [Opera House Game](#) on this site is seventeen moves of exactly this point being proved.

Study tactics, regularly and in small doses

Tactics decide club games. Learn to spot the recurring patterns until you see them without looking:

- **Pins** — a piece that cannot move without exposing something more valuable
- **Skewers** — the same idea, with the valuable piece in front
- **Discovered attacks** — moving one piece to unleash another
- **Forks** — one piece attacking two targets, the knight's speciality

Fifteen minutes of puzzles a day beats three hours once a fortnight. The [lichess puzzle trainer](#) is free and adjusts to your level.

Build a small opening repertoire and understand it

You need far less opening knowledge than you think, but you need to understand what you do know. Pick one reply as White and one against each of 1.e4 and 1.d4, and learn the resulting *positions* — where the pieces belong, which pawn structures arise, what the typical plans are. The Italian Game is a good starting point for White because the ideas are clear and the structures repeat.

Memorising twenty moves of a line you do not understand is worse than useless, because you will be lost on move twenty-one.

Learn to play the middlegame with a plan

Once the pieces are out, ask three questions: which of my pieces is worst placed and how do I improve it; where are the weak squares in my opponent's position; and which side of the board should I be playing on. A mediocre plan followed consistently beats a series of individually reasonable moves with no plan behind them.

Take endgames seriously

This is the biggest single source of dropped points at club level. Start with:

- **King and pawn against king** — the opposition, and which squares matter
- **Rook endings** — the most common ending in practice, and the least understood
- **Basic mates** — king and queen, king and rook, delivered without thinking

There is a [rook ending puzzle](#) on the site that shows the sort of thing worth knowing cold.

Learn from your own games, especially the losses

Go through every league game you lose. Not with an engine first — do it yourself, write down where you think it went wrong, and *then* check. The recurring mistakes are the ones worth fixing, and you will only find them by looking at your own games rather than grandmaster ones.

Do not neglect the mental side

Calculate concretely rather than hoping. Practise visualising two or three moves ahead without touching the pieces. And learn to sit on your hands when you find a good move: spend thirty more seconds checking it is not refuted.

Play stronger opponents in a real club

Online blitz is entertaining and it will not make you much better. Long games against stronger opposition, over the board, with the post-mortem afterwards, will. That is precisely what a club night is for — and the conversation at the bar after the game is often where the most instructive chess of the evening happens.

Stay curious

Read about the game. Follow a tournament. Look at the games of a player whose style appeals to you. The people who improve most are usually the ones who simply find chess interesting, and keep turning up.

New to the club? We meet every Tuesday at the Massey Ferguson Social Club from 7:30pm — just come along, or [send us a message](#) first if you prefer. Our [junior section](#) runs earlier on the same evening, and [one-to-one coaching](#) is available for both adults and juniors.

More from the club

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Fixtures

Last updated 4 August 2026

Our season runs from early October through to the following May, with the Summer Cup filling the weeks after the league programme finishes. Club nights are every Tuesday at the Massey Ferguson Social Club from 7:30pm, whether or not a match is scheduled.

League fixtures

Full fixture lists and up-to-date results for both leagues we play in are published by the leagues themselves:

- [Coventry & District Chess League](#) — fixtures, tables and news
- [Coventry League results on the ECF LMS](#) — match cards as they are submitted
- [Leamington & District Chess League](#) — our Division 4 side

The season at a glance

Period	What is on
Early October	Season opens; league matches begin
December	First half of the league season closes; club nights continue for social chess
January	League matches resume
March	Club rapidplay tournament, then the Summer Cup begins
April – May	Summer Cup rounds, with a free week over Easter
May	Club AGM (members only)
June	League AGM

Exact dates are announced on the [club blog](#) as each part of the season is confirmed, so that is the place to check before travelling to a match.

Home matches

Home fixtures are played at the Massey Ferguson Social Club, Broad Lane, Coventry. There is parking on site and a bar. Visiting teams are always welcome — please arrive for a 7:30pm start.

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Fun Stuff

Last updated 4 August 2026

Chess to enjoy away from the league programme: puzzles, curiosities and positions worth a second look.

Try this one

White is a rook down but has one move that settles the game. Board set from Black's side, as it was played.



White to move · White to play. What is the fastest win?

[► Show the answer](#)

Puzzles every day

- [Lichess daily puzzle](#) — free, unlimited, and rated so the difficulty adapts to you
- [Lichess practice](#) — guided lessons on checkmates, endgames and tactical motifs
- [Lichess coordinate trainer](#) — surprisingly useful for reading notation quickly

Worth reading

The [How to improve at chess](#) article on our blog collects the practical advice our stronger players give most often — study your own losses, learn a small repertoire properly, and do tactics puzzles regularly rather than in bursts.

Play us online

Several club members play on [lichess](#) between club nights. Ask around on a Tuesday for handles, or set up a casual game with someone you have just played over the board — it is a good way to keep a rivalry going through the summer.

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Contact the club

Thinking of coming along, asking about the junior section, or arranging a match? Send us a message and one of the club officers will reply.

Your name *

Email address *

Telephone (optional)

What is it about? *

General enquiry



Subject (optional)

Message *

If you are asking about the junior section, it helps to mention the child's age and any experience they already have.

Send message

We use your details only to reply to this enquiry.

COME AND SEE US

You do not need to contact us first — just turn up on a Tuesday evening from 7:30pm.

Massey Ferguson Social Club

Broad Lane, Coventry
CV5 7NL

[Open in maps](#) →

JUNIOR SECTION

Our junior section runs Tuesday, 6:00pm – 7:15pm. Places are limited, so please get in touch before bringing a young player along for the first time.

CLUB MEMBERS

Already a member and want to write for the site? [Sign in here](#). Accounts are set up by the club administrators.

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Members' login

This area is for Coventry Chess Club members. Accounts are created by the club administrators — there is no public sign-up.

Email address

Password

☐ Keep me signed in on this device

Sign in

Been added to the club whitelist but not set your password yet? **Create your account.**

Forgotten your password? Please **contact a club administrator**, who can reset it for you.

[← Back to the club website](#)

Create your account

Accounts are for club members only. Your email address must already have been added to the club whitelist by an administrator — if it has not, please **ask us to add you** first.

Your name

Email address

Use the address the club has on file for you.

Choose a password

At least 8 characters, including a letter and a number.

Confirm your password

Create my account

Already have an account? [Sign in](#).

Hello, Simon Weaver

You are signed in as a club administrator. You can publish and edit any post, manage the whitelist and edit the club's pages.

MY POSTS

6

MY DRAFTS

0

UNREAD ENQUIRIES

0

ACTIVE MEMBERS

2

1 invitation not yet used

Write something



General post

Club news, fixtures, results or an article.



Chess position

A diagram from a FEN — puzzles and study positions.



Annotated game

Paste a PGN or drop in a .pgn file.

Recently edited

[See all](#)

The Opera House Game, and what it still teaches us

Annotated game · Rhys Edwards · edited 45 minutes ago

LIVE

Edit

Club night puzzle: a rook ending worth knowing

Position · Rhys Edwards · edited 45 minutes ago

LIVE

Edit

End of season dates for 2026

News · Simon Weaver · edited 45 minutes ago

LIVE

Edit

How to improve at chess

News · Simon Weaver · edited 45 minutes ago

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Summer information and coaching details

News · Simon Weaver · edited 45 minutes ago

LIVE

Edit

Adding a board inside any post

You can drop a diagram into the middle of any post — including a general news post — by adding a fenced block to the body:

```
'''fen
r1bqkbnr/pppp1ppp/2n5/4p3/2B1P3/5N2/PPPP1PPP/RNBQK2R b KQkq - 5 4
Caption: How should Black meet the threat?
Orientation: black
Solution: 4...Nf6 keeps the balance.
'''
```

The `Caption`, `Orientation` and `Solution` lines are all optional.

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All posts

8 posts across the whole site.

Title	Type	Author	Status	Updated	
The Opera House Game, and what it still teaches us	Annotated game	Rhys Edwards	LIVE	4 Aug 2026	Edit
Club night puzzle: a rook ending worth knowing	Position	Rhys Edwards	LIVE	4 Aug 2026	Edit
End of season dates for 2026 FEATURED	News	Simon Weaver	LIVE	4 Aug 2026	Edit
How to improve at chess	News	Simon Weaver	LIVE	4 Aug 2026	Edit
Summer information and coaching details	News	Simon Weaver	LIVE	4 Aug 2026	Edit
Spring and summer 2025 dates	News	Simon Weaver	LIVE	4 Aug 2026	Edit
Christmas and new year opening times	News	Simon Weaver	LIVE	4 Aug 2026	Edit
Malcolm Harding: funeral arrangements	News	Simon Weaver	LIVE	4 Aug 2026	Edit

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Write a post

Choose the kind of post, fill in the details, and either save it as a draft or publish it.

What kind of post is this?

This decides which fields you get. You can change it at any time.

General post

News, fixtures, results or an article.

Chess position

One diagram, built from a FEN.

Annotated game

A full game from a PGN.

Title *

Summary (optional)

Shown on the blog index and in link previews. Left blank, we use the opening of your post.

The game

Paste the PGN, or drop a .pgn file onto the box. Comments in {curly braces} become the annotations readers see beside each move.

PGN

```
[Event "Coventry League Division 1"]
[White "Smith, J"]
[Black "Jones, A"]
[Result "1-0"]

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bb5 {The Spanish. } a6 ...
```

Choose a .pgn file

Paste a PGN, or drop a .pgn file onto the box above.

White

Black

Result

Not stated

Date played

mm/dd/yyyy

Event or competition

Coventry & District League, Division 1

Show the board from

White's side

Black's side

Preview

Notes and commentary (optional)

Formatting

Markdown: ## Heading , **bold** , *italic* , - lists , [link](https://...) , and tables.

To drop a board into the text, use a fenced block starting with ```fen , the FEN on the next line, then optional Caption: , Orientation: and Solution: lines.

Publishing

☐ Publish this post

Unticked, it stays a draft that only you and the administrators can see.

☐ Feature on the home page

Pins this post to the top of the home page.

Publication date (optional)

mm/dd/yyyy, --:-- --

Leave blank to use the moment you publish. A future date schedules it.

Save post

Cancel

Tick "Publish this post" above to make it live straight away.



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Annotated game

A full game from a PGN.

Title *

Round four: a patient Spanish win

Summary (optional)

Shown on the blog index and in link previews. Left blank, we use the opening of your post.

The game

Paste the PGN, or drop a .pgn file onto the box. Comments in {curly braces} become the annotations readers see beside each move.

PGN

```
[Event "Coventry & District League, Division 1"]
[White "Smith, J"]
[Black "Jones, A"]
[Result "1-0"]
[Date "2026.02.10"]

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bb5 a6 4. Ba4 Nf6 5. O-O Be7 {A solid Spanish setup.}
6. Re1 b5 7. Bb3 d6 8. c3 O-O 9. h3 Nb8 10. d4 Nbd7 1-0
```

Choose a .pgn file

Valid game — 20 moves, 1 annotated, result 1-0.

White

Smith, J

Black

Jones, A

Result

White won (1-0)

Date played

02/10/2026

Event or competition

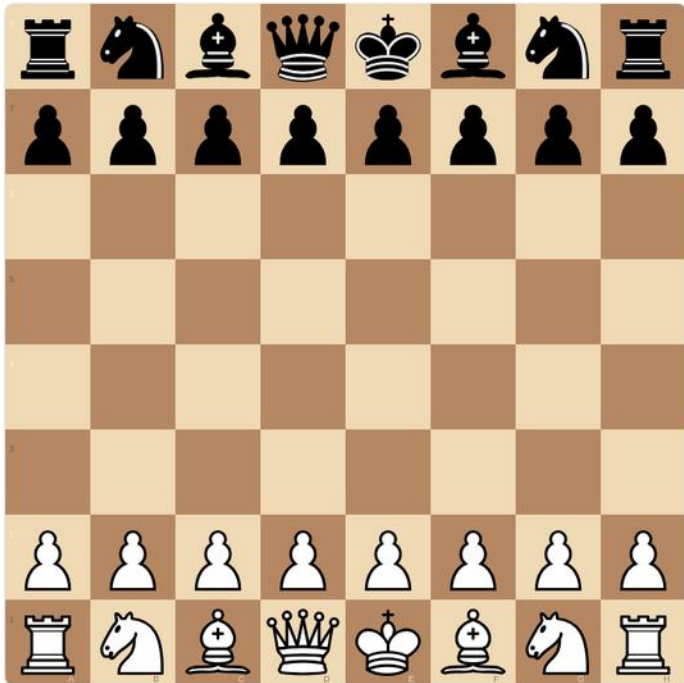
Coventry & District League, Division 1

Show the board from

White's side

Black's side

Preview



Starting position

MOVES

- | | | |
|------------------------|-----|------|
| 1. | e4 | e5 |
| 2. | Nf3 | Nc6 |
| 3. | Bb5 | a6 |
| 4. | Ba4 | Nf6 |
| 5. | O-O | Be7 |
| A solid Spanish setup. | | |
| 6. | Re1 | b5 |
| 7. | Bb3 | d6 |
| 8. | c3 | O-O |
| 9. | h3 | Nb8 |
| 10. | d4 | Nbd7 |

POSITION (FEN)

rnbqkbnr/pppppppp/8/8/8/PPPPPPPP/RN

Notes and commentary (optional)

Formatting

Markdown: # Heading , **bold** , *italic* , - lists , [link](https://...) , and tables.

To drop a board into the text, use a fenced block starting with ```fen , the FEN on the next line, then optional Caption: , Orientation: and Solution: lines.

Publishing

☐ Publish this post

Unticked, it stays a draft that only you and the administrators can see.

☐ Feature on the home page

Pins this post to the top of the home page.

Publication date (optional)

mm/dd/yyyy, --:-- --

Leave blank to use the moment you publish. A future date schedules it.

Save post

Cancel

Tick "Publish this post" above to make it live straight away.

 Coventry Chess Club

Chess in Coventry every Tuesday evening — all standards welcome.
We play in the Coventry & District League and the Leamington & District League, and run a junior section on club nights.

Get in touch →

CLUB NIGHT

Every Tuesday, from 7:30pm
Massey Ferguson Social Club
Broad Lane, Coventry
CV5 7NL
[Find us on the map](#)

CHESS LINKS

Fixtures
Teams
1-1 Coaching
Juniors
Coventry & District League
Leamington League
English Chess Federation

Write a post

Choose the kind of post, fill in the details, and either save it as a draft or publish it.

What kind of post is this?

This decides which fields you get. You can change it at any time.

General post

News, fixtures, results or an article.

Chess position

One diagram, built from a FEN.

Annotated game

A full game from a PGN.

Title *

Summary (optional)

Shown on the blog index and in link previews. Left blank, we use the opening of your post.

The position

Paste a FEN, or set the position up by dragging pieces on the board — the FEN keeps itself in step. Dragging a piece off the board removes it.



Starting position

Empty board

Flip view

FEN

rnbqkbnr/pppppppp/8/8/8/PPPPPPPP/RNBQKBNR w KQkq - 0 1

Valid position — White to move.

Side to move

White

Black

Show the board from

White's side

Black's side

Caption (optional)

White to play and win

Answer (optional)

1. Qh6+! gxh6 2. Rg8#

Hidden behind a "Show the answer" toggle, so readers can try it first.

Notes and commentary (optional)

Formatting

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Members and whitelist

Nobody can create an account unless their email address appears on this whitelist. Add an address, send the person their invitation link, and they choose their own password.

Add someone to the whitelist

Email address *

Name (optional)

Access level

Club member ▾

Notes (optional)

e.g. A team captain, joined September 2026

[Add to whitelist](#)

Administrators can manage every post, page, enquiry and account.

Whitelist

Unused invitations are listed first. Copy an invitation link and send it to the member.

A New Member MEMBER

newmember@example.com

Invitation not used yet · added by Simon Weaver

Joined on a club night; invitation not yet used.

[New link](#)

[Remove](#)

<http://127.0.0.1:8000/register?token=waEMkyIPpZj73zZKBYixkcmaLDPONBTFRTldPJlYjt9Indb>

[Copy](#)

Club Administrator ADMIN

admin@coventrychessclub.test

Account created 4 Aug 2026 by Simon Weaver

Founding administrator, created by the installer.

[Remove](#)

Rhys Edwards MEMBER

member@coventrychessclub.test

Account created 4 Aug 2026 by Rhys Edwards · added by Simon Weaver

A team, board one. Runs the coaching.

[Remove](#)

Accounts

Change someone's access level, or suspend an account to revoke access immediately.

SW

Simon Weaver (you)

admin@coventrychessclub.test · 6 posts

Administrator ▾

☒ Active

[Save](#)

RE

Rhys Edwards

member@coventrychessclub.test · 2 posts

Club member ▾

☒ Active

[Save](#)

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Enquiries

Messages sent through the contact form. They are stored here only, because no notification address has been configured yet.

[Inbox](#)[Archived](#)

No enquiries yet

Messages from the [contact page](#) will appear here.

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Pages

Managing pages such as Fixtures, Teams and Coaching. Pages ticked to show in the navigation appear in the site menu, ordered by their position number.

[New page](#)

10	Fixtures /fixtures · updated 4 Aug 2026	LIVE	IN MENU	View	Edit
20	Teams /teams · updated 4 Aug 2026	LIVE	IN MENU	View	Edit
30	1-1 Coaching /1-1-coaching · updated 4 Aug 2026	LIVE	IN MENU	View	Edit
40	Juniors /juniors · updated 4 Aug 2026	LIVE	IN MENU	View	Edit
50	Fun Stuff /fun-stuff · updated 4 Aug 2026	LIVE		View	Edit
60	Useful Links /useful-links · updated 4 Aug 2026	LIVE		View	Edit

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My profile

Your name appears on the posts you write. Your email address is used only for signing in.

Your details

Full name

Name shown on posts (optional)

Leave blank to use your full name.

Email address

ECF code (optional)

ECF rating (optional)

A line about you (optional)

[Save profile](#)

Change your password

Current password

New password

At least 8 characters, including a letter and a number.

Confirm new password

[Change password](#)

Your account

Access level

Administrator

Member since

August 2026

Posts written

6

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